

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

IBM — Deep-tier diligence review. 36 finding(s) across 6 source(s), 1 research round(s). Overall confidence: **low**. Highest risk band observed: **High**.

Deterministic synthesis (provider_error: Error code: 400 - {'type': 'error', 'error': {'type': 'invalid_request_error', 'message': 'Your credit balance is too low to access the Anthropic API. Please go to Plans & Billing to upgrade or purchase credits.'}, 'request_id': 'req_011CcNt7iAeV4EuviyoniXuC'}): 36 finding(s) across 6 source table(s), clustered by source. No automated risk, opportunity, or cross-finding assessment was produced — this is a placeholder, not an analysis. Have an analyst review the findings directly.

2. OVERALL RISK

High		3
Elevated		3
Watch		30

36 finding(s): 3 high, 3 elevated, 30 watch.

Highest-severity findings:

- HIGH

 Ibm Canada Ltd. — Information Technology and Telecom Consultants — \$108,882,490 from Public Services and Procurement Canada | Services publics et Approvisionnement Canada (dated 2022-03-28) — IBM Canada Ltd. received a federal contract for Information Technology and Telecom Consulting services from Public Services and Procurement Canada (PSPC) valued at over \$108 million, awarded in March 2022. This places IBM Canada among significant IT vendors to the federal government, with PSPC acting as the central procurement authority. Contextual records indicate IBM Canada has a long-standing and multi-faceted relationship with the Government of Canada, including prior large contracts, lobbying activity dating back to the 1990s, and participation in government technology and AI initiatives. The scale of this contract suggests IBM Canada is positioned as a major incumbent supplier in the federal IT and telecom consulting market. — *A contract of this magnitude with PSPC may signal strong incumbency in federal IT and telecom consulting, which could represent both a revenue concentration risk (dependency on a single dominant client) and a competitive moat. Stakeholders assessing IBM Canada's government business footprint should consider the renewal risk, competitive procurement exposure, and the regulatory and policy environment governing large federal IT contracts. The existence of prior lobbying registrations and communications with government departments adds a dimension of government-relations activity that may be relevant to understanding how this relationship was cultivated and maintained.* [contracts:1139805](#)

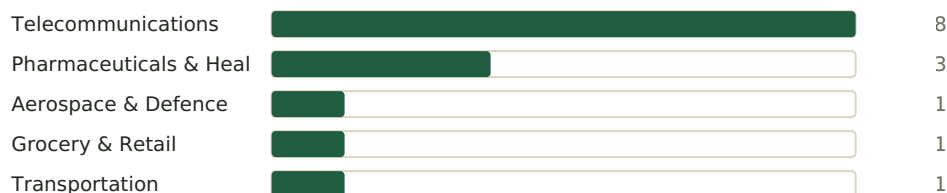
- **HIGH** IBM CANADA LTD. received a contract titled "Information technology and telecommunications consultants" valued at \$303,096,629.16 from Public Services and Procurement Canada | Services publics et Approvisionnement Canada, dated 2022-01-24. — This contract represents a substantial federal IT and telecommunications consulting engagement awarded to IBM Canada Ltd. by Canada's central procurement authority. The scale of the award places it among larger single-contract engagements visible in the retrieved dataset. Contextual records indicate IBM Canada Ltd. also received a separate IT and Telecom Consultants contract of \$108,882,490 from the same department approximately two months later (2022-03-28), and a historical Management Consulting contract of \$150,436,284 from the same department dated 2011. Taken together, these records suggest a recurring and multi-contract procurement relationship between IBM Canada Ltd. and Public Services and Procurement Canada spanning over a decade. IBM Canada Ltd.'s lobbying activity and long-standing registration history (records dating to 1996–1997) and a more recent semiconductor partnership announcement with the federal government may indicate broad and ongoing government engagement across multiple departments and policy areas. — *The magnitude of this single contract (\$303M+) and its proximity in date to a second large contract from the same department (\$108M+, March 2022) may indicate significant ongoing federal revenue concentration for IBM Canada Ltd. with a single government counterparty. For due-diligence purposes, this concentration of federal procurement relationships may be material to assessments of regulatory exposure, supplier dependency, or competitive procurement dynamics.* [contracts:1154402](#)

+1 more finding(s) — see Evidence appendix.

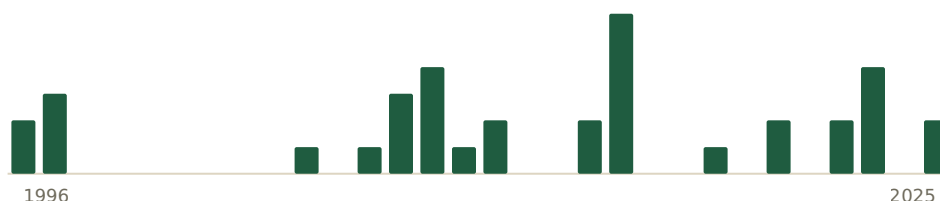
3. COMPANY & SECTOR EXPOSURE

Declared scope: technology.

Evidence touches: Telecommunications (8), Pharmaceuticals & Health (3), Aerospace & Defence (1), Grocery & Retail (1), Transportation (1).



4. MATERIAL DEVELOPMENTS



- **WATCH** Canada invests in the semiconductor sector in partnership with IBM Canada and C2MI — The project will increase advanced packaging and commercialization capabilities (dated 2025-11-28) — This record indicates a Government of Canada investment in the semiconductor sector involving IBM Canada and C2MI, focused on advanced packaging and commercialization capabilities. The nature of the partnership suggests IBM Canada is positioned as a recipient or co-delivery partner for public funds

directed toward domestic semiconductor capability-building. Combined with context records showing IBM Canada's history of large federal contracts (IT consulting and management consulting) and registered lobbying activity with federal departments, this finding may reflect an ongoing and deepening relationship between IBM Canada and the federal government across technology policy domains, including emerging areas such as semiconductors. — *The partnership may signal that IBM Canada is expanding its footprint within Canadian federal technology investment priorities beyond traditional IT services. For due-diligence purposes, this could affect assessments of IBM Canada's revenue exposure to government funding cycles, its strategic alignment with national industrial policy, and the durability of its public-sector relationships. The involvement of C2MI as a co-partner introduces a secondary organizational relationship that may carry its own government funding and regulatory considerations.* [source_records:373307](#)

- **ELEVATED** Canada invests in the semiconductor sector in partnership with IBM Canada and C2MI — The project will increase advanced packaging and commercialization capabilities (dated 2025-11-28) — The Canadian government has announced a partnership investment with IBM Canada and C2MI (Centre de Collaboration MiQro Innovation) directed at the semiconductor sector, specifically targeting advanced packaging and commercialization capabilities. This suggests a public-private collaboration intended to strengthen domestic semiconductor industrial capacity. Contextual records indicate IBM Canada has a long-standing relationship with the federal government, including prior lobbying activity (2008), lobbying registrations (1996–1997), a major management consulting contract (\$150.4M, 2011), and a significant IT/telecom consulting contract (\$108.9M, 2022), as well as IBM's 2023 sign-on to Canada's voluntary AI code of conduct. This pattern indicates IBM Canada is a recurring federal government partner across multiple technology domains. — *The announcement may signal expanding federal financial exposure to IBM Canada in a strategically sensitive industrial sector (semiconductors). The involvement of C2MI, a Quebec-based microelectronics hub, suggests potential regional economic and industrial policy dimensions. The absence of a disclosed investment amount in the record limits assessment of the financial scope of this commitment relative to prior federal contracts with IBM Canada.* [source_records:73520](#)

+34 more finding(s) — see Evidence appendix.

5. LEGISLATIVE & REGULATORY

Insufficient evidence in this run for this section.

6. GOVERNMENT SUPPORT & DEPENDENCIES

- **HIGH** IBM — Management Consulting — \$150,436,284 from Public Services and Procurement Canada | Services publics et Approvisionnement Canada (dated 2011-06-29) — This record indicates that IBM received a management consulting contract valued at over \$150 million from Public Services and Procurement Canada (PSPC) in 2011. Contracts of this scale awarded by the federal government's central procurement authority suggest a significant and established vendor relationship between IBM and the Government of Canada. Contextual records indicate that IBM Canada has maintained a long-running pattern of federal engagement, including additional large IT/telecom consulting contracts (e.g., \$108.8M in 2022), lobbying activity dating back to at least 1996, and more recent involvement in government-backed semiconductor and AI initiatives. Together, these suggest a multi-decade commercial relationship with the federal government across multiple program areas. — *A contract of this magnitude from PSPC signals IBM's deep integration into federal government operations. For due-diligence purposes, this may be relevant to assessing IBM Canada's revenue dependence on public-sector clients, the competitiveness of the procurement process, any associated subcontracting or partnership arrangements, and continuity risks if*

the government relationship were to change. It may also be relevant in assessing whether any related parties have conflicts of interest tied to federal procurement. [contracts:1115671](#)

- **WATCH** Libman, Eva — Research Partnerships — \$7,000 grant from Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada | Conseil de recherches en sciences humaines du Canada, dated 2023-03-01. — Eva Libman received a modest federal research grant under SSHRC's Research Partnerships program in early 2023. The Research Partnerships program is designed to support collaborative work between academic researchers and non-academic partners (e.g., community organizations, government bodies, or private-sector entities). The relatively small grant amount (\$7,000) is consistent with a partnership development or connection grant rather than a full research project award, suggesting this may represent an early-stage or supplementary collaborative engagement rather than a major funded research program. — *The existence of this SSHRC Research Partnerships grant may indicate that Libman has or had a formal partnership relationship with one or more non-academic organizations, which could be commercially relevant if any such partner overlaps with counterparties in the transaction under review. The grant's federal funding origin also establishes a public funding relationship with the Government of Canada as of 2023. [grants:1081907](#)*

+10 more finding(s) — see Evidence appendix.

7. LOBBYING & STAKEHOLDERS

- **WATCH** IBM Canada Limited lobbied Foreign Affairs and International Trade Canada (DFAITC), with Dan Fortin listed as registrant, on 2008-07-07. — This lobbying communication record indicates that IBM Canada Limited engaged with the federal department responsible for Canada's trade and foreign policy portfolio in mid-2008. Engagement with DFAITC by a major technology company may relate to trade policy, export controls, international procurement, or cross-border technology transfer matters relevant to IBM's commercial interests at that time. A near-contemporaneous second communication with the same department and registrant (dated 2008-08-04, [lobbying:332491](#)) suggests this was part of a sustained engagement effort rather than a one-off interaction. Older OCL registration records ([ocl_registrations:15714](#), [ocl_registrations:15789](#)) also confirm IBM Canada has maintained a lobbying presence in Canada since at least the mid-1990s. — *Sustained lobbying of DFAITC by a major technology vendor may indicate efforts to shape trade policy, market access conditions, or government procurement rules that could affect IBM Canada's competitive position in federal contracting or international trade. Context from other records showing significant federal contracts ([contracts:1115671](#), [contracts:1139805](#)) and more recent government partnerships ([source_records:373307](#), [source_records:73520](#)) suggests IBM Canada has maintained a long-term government-relations strategy alongside its commercial relationship with the federal government. [lobbying:332490](#)*
- **WATCH** IBM CANADA LIMITED registration (CANADIAN PUBLIC AFFAIRS CONSULTING GROUP INC.) dated 1996-11-13, recorded as a lobbying_registration in the OCL registrations table. No amount, no subject matter, and no snippet text are included in the record. — This record documents that IBM Canada Limited engaged Canadian Public Affairs Consulting Group Inc. as a registered lobbyist in November 1996. The engagement indicates that IBM Canada was active in consulting the federal government through a third-party consulting firm at that time. Viewed alongside a subsequent OCL registration in January 1997 (with no named consultant firm), this suggests IBM Canada maintained a pattern of federal lobbying activity in the mid-to-late 1990s. The absence of subject-matter detail in the record limits visibility into what policy areas or government departments were being targeted. — *The existence of a lobbying registration using a third-party consulting firm suggests IBM Canada had organized government-relations activity at the federal level in 1996. While this record is nearly three decades old, it establishes an early baseline of IBM Canada's engagement with federal institutions, which may be relevant when assessing the continuity or evolution of the company's government-relations posture across a broader diligence timeline. [ocl_registrations:15714](#)*

+10 more finding(s) — see Evidence appendix.

8. POLITICAL & REPUTATIONAL ATTENTION

- **WATCH** Canada invests in the semiconductor sector in partnership with IBM Canada and C2MI — The project will increase advanced packaging and commercialization capabilities (dated 2025-11-28) — This record indicates a Government of Canada investment in the semiconductor sector involving IBM Canada and C2MI, focused on advanced packaging and commercialization capabilities. The nature of the partnership suggests IBM Canada is positioned as a recipient or co-delivery partner for public funds directed toward domestic semiconductor capability-building. Combined with context records showing IBM Canada's history of large federal contracts (IT consulting and management consulting) and registered lobbying activity with federal departments, this finding may reflect an ongoing and deepening relationship between IBM Canada and the federal government across technology policy domains, including emerging areas such as semiconductors. — *The partnership may signal that IBM Canada is expanding its footprint within Canadian federal technology investment priorities beyond traditional IT services. For due-diligence purposes, this could affect assessments of IBM Canada's revenue exposure to government funding cycles, its strategic alignment with national industrial policy, and the durability of its public-sector relationships. The involvement of C2MI as a co-partner introduces a secondary organizational relationship that may carry its own government funding and regulatory considerations.* [source_records:373307](#)
- **WATCH** Carsley, Cynthia made a \$1,000 donation to the Conservative Party of Canada, recorded in Quebec (QC), dated 2015-10-13. — The record shows a single political donation of \$1,000 to the Conservative Party of Canada from an individual named Cynthia Carsley, made in Quebec during the federal election period of October 2015. This reflects a disclosed partisan political affiliation at that point in time. The donation falls within the legal limits for individual contributions under the Canada Elections Act. No organizational affiliation is indicated in the record itself, so the commercial or institutional relevance of this affiliation depends on who Cynthia Carsley is in the context of the broader diligence subject matter. — *If Cynthia Carsley holds or has held a position of influence relevant to the diligence subject, her disclosed partisan affiliation with the Conservative Party of Canada as of October 2015 may be relevant to assessing potential political risk, access patterns, or reputational considerations — particularly in contexts involving government relations, regulatory decisions, or public procurement. The single data point is limited without broader context about her role or relationship to the subject entity.* [donations:103693](#)

+10 more finding(s) — see Evidence appendix.

9. KEY ACTORS

Insufficient evidence in this run for this section.

10. CROSS-SOURCE CONNECTIONS

Insufficient evidence in this run for this section.

11. UPCOMING EVENTS

Nessus retrieves historical public records, not a forward calendar — the most recently dated activity is shown as the closest available signal for forthcoming developments.

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+8 more finding(s) — see Evidence appendix.

12. RISKS

Insufficient evidence in this run for this section.

13. OPPORTUNITIES

Insufficient evidence in this run for this section.

14. QUESTIONS FOR MANAGEMENT

1. Have these findings been reviewed by an analyst?

15. FURTHER INVESTIGATION

- [interpretation_cap_reached](#) INTERPRETATION CAP REACHED
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16. EVIDENCE APPENDIX

SOURCE	RECORD	DATE	LINK
Breadth sources	source_records:381392	2020-05-12	record
Breadth sources	source_records:339042	2020-12-19	record

SOURCE	RECORD	DATE	LINK
Breadth sources	source_records:373723	2023-12-07	record
Breadth sources	source_records:79547	2023-12-07	record
Breadth sources	source_records:373307	2025-11-28	record
Breadth sources	source_records:73520	2025-11-28	record
Federal contracts	contracts:54047	2007-10-31	record
Federal contracts	contracts:1115671	2011-06-29	record
Federal contracts	contracts:191650	2014-10-20	record
Federal contracts	contracts:191931	2014-10-20	record
Federal contracts	contracts:1154402	2022-01-24	record
Federal contracts	contracts:1139805	2022-03-28	record
Grants & contributions	grants:749511	2009-10-01	record
Grants & contributions	grants:749232	2010-08-30	record
Grants & contributions	grants:748975	2011-09-30	record
Grants & contributions	grants:165074	2018-04-01	record
Grants & contributions	grants:748292	2023-01-01	record
Grants & contributions	grants:1081907	2023-03-01	record
Lobbying communications	lobbying:332490	2008-07-07	record
Lobbying communications	lobbying:332492	2008-07-16	record
Lobbying communications	lobbying:332491	2008-08-04	record
Lobbying communications	lobbying:333462	2009-04-09	record
Lobbying communications	lobbying:333463	2009-04-21	record
Lobbying communications	lobbying:333143	2009-07-17	record
Lobbying registrations	ocl_registrations:15790	1996-02-12	record
Lobbying registrations	ocl_registrations:15714	1996-11-13	record
Lobbying registrations	ocl_registrations:15789	1997-01-23	record
Lobbying registrations	ocl_registrations:15886	1997-01-29	record
Lobbying registrations	ocl_registrations:15796	1997-02-26	record
Lobbying registrations	ocl_registrations:2879	2005-08-11	record
Political donations	donations:103696	2015-09-01	record
Political donations	donations:103700	2015-09-05	record
Political donations	donations:103701	2015-09-24	record
Political donations	donations:103703	2015-09-29	record
Political donations	donations:103693	2015-10-13	record
Political donations	donations:103702	2015-10-13	record

17. COVERAGE & LIMITATIONS

Breadth sources		6
Federal contracts		6
Political donations		6
Grants & contributions		6
Lobbying communication		6
Lobbying registrations		6

Rounds: 1/6 · Interpretations: 36/36 · Model calls: 37 · Provider: claude · Synthesis method:
Deterministic fallback — analyst review required.